

These are also called the five classes designated as *Kavarga*, *Chavarga*, *Tavarga*, *Tavarga*, and *Pavarga* respectively.

(b) Semivowels—य y, र, र, ल l, व v.

(c) Sibilants—श श् sh, स s.

(d) Sonant Aspirate—ह h.

Besides these we have two more characters occurring in the Veda, viz. ऌ and ॡ (often substituted for इ and ए; as ईळे for ईडे, मीळहुषे for मीहुषे &c.) In Maráthi ऌ is generally substituted for the final ल of Sanskrit words.

§ 5. The first two letters of the five classes and the sibilants are called *sunds* or *hard consonants*. The rest are called *sonants* or *soft consonants*.

§ 6. In addition to the characters given above there are in Sanskrit two nasal sounds:—the one called *Anusvāra*, is denoted by [˙] i. e. a dot placed above the letter after which it is to be pronounced, e. g. कं; the other, called *Anunāsika* is denoted by ° i. e. a dot within a semi-circle placed above the letter after which it is to be pronounced e. g. कैं.

(a) And a sort of hard breathing is known as *Visarga* (generally called *Visarjanīya* by Sanskrit grammarians). It is denoted by the sign : i. e. two vertical dots placed after the letter after which it is to be pronounced. In pronunciation it is a harder aspirate than ह्. The *Visarga* is not an original character but only a substitute for a final स s or र r.

(b) *Jihvámūliya* (जिह्वामूलिय) and *Upadhmanīya* (उपध्मानीय) are terms given to a sort of Semi-*Visarga*, when pronounced before क् ख्, and प् फ् respectively. It is written symbolically

as ~. These may be regarded as the spirants of *Kavarga* and *Paravarga* respectively.

§ 7. Some consonants are pronounced with a slight aspiration and are designated as *Alpa-prāṇa*, while others which are pronounced with a stronger aspiration are called *Mahā-prāṇa*. The first and third letters of each class, the nasals and the semi-vowels belong to the first class; the rest belong to the second class. For the sake of convenience the first and third letters of each class are sometimes called "unaspirates."

§ 8. In the following table is given a complete classification of these letters according to the organs with which they are pronounced.

(a) The organs of pronunciation are the five parts situated in the mouth, viz, the throat, the palate, the roof or upper part of the palate, the teeth and the lips.

Note.—In the following table the nether stroke (see § a 10 below) is omitted. It should be supposed to be present.

	The Five Classes.					Semi-vowels.	Sibilants.	Simple vowels St Lg.	Dip-thongs.
	Unas-pirate	Aspi-rate.	Unas-pirate	Aspi-rate.	Na-sals.				
Gutturals	क	ख	ग	घ	ङ	ॠ	(Jiv. अ, आ	} ए ओ	ओ औ
Palatals.	च	छ	ज	झ	ञ	य	श इ ई		
Linguals.	ट	ठ	ड	ढ	ण	र	ष ऋ ॠ		
Dentals.	त	थ	द	ध	न	ल } व	(स ल	उ, ऊ	ओ औ
Labials.	प	फ	ब	भ	म		Upa. उ, ऊ		

* इ though not a semivowel is put here as it is a guttural.